

2. The next problem developers face is the documentation. Since the app has to be installed on top of the Android OS, the app developer should know what APIs (read functions) can be used in the code. For example, if the developer wants the app to use the camera (the mobile camera), how should it be accessed? The documentation can be looked up to find the function and it can be called in the app. This makes it very easy for the developer to quickly develop the app, since one needs to concentrate only on the app's functionality and not the nitty gritty of the operating system.
3. With the app developed, you may want more and more users to be able to access it and probably get paid as well. There is a portal, the Google Play store, where developers can get apps hosted and earn revenue. A user gets millions of apps to choose from at a single place. The Play store is not the only way to get an app; the .apk file of the app can be installed on Android phones directly, as well. Look up Google to find out more on this.
4. Coming back to the Android OS, since the code is open source and readily available for people to download and change, more and more variants of the OS, adapted to different hardware platforms, are also coming up. You can soon expect a set-top box, a refrigerator, or a washing machine with Android. But too many cooks

spoil the soup! If everyone takes the code and does whatever they want to do with it, how can there be standardisation? Google has a solution; it's called the Compatibility Test Suite (CTS). It is a test suite based on the JUnit framework and validates the adapted Android implementation. So, even if it is open source and can be adapted as desired, there is a standard operating system and the new implementation should conform to it before being called Android. This makes Android very easy to adapt and implement for new hardware platforms.

Continuous innovation by the open source community and of course, Google, has advanced Android and the march continues.

I hope this article has given you some insight into how Android and the related mechanisms work together to give users a wholesome experience. This article ends here, but the Android story goes on! **END** 

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